CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

CONTENT STRATEGIST IN THE AI ERA

Strategy decks are easy to generate now. What's scarce is owning a result.

★ TL;DR — NO. Median ~$75K (a proxy figure — BLS doesn't even track this title) — and it isn't an entry job: nobody starts as a strategist. The ramp in runs through junior content roles, exactly the layer AI is eating. The roadmap below is the way OUT, not in. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

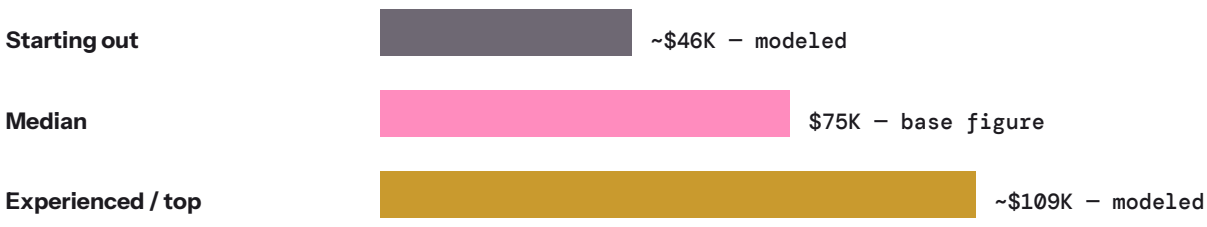
OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK HIGH

- Fails as a start because: it is not an entry occupation — you enter through junior copy, SEO-assistant and coordinator roles, and those are the jobs being automated and de-posted first.
- The money problem: a ~$75K proxy median for a role companies increasingly fold into one marketer plus software — every BLS proxy around it (editors −1%, writers 0%, PR +2%) is flat or shrinking.
- Still worth money: positioning judgment — knowing what a business should say and to whom. That pays where judgment meets data: audience research and lifecycle marketing.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Content Strategist is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a market/anchor estimate)). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state

before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A CONTENT STRATEGIST ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Audit a brand's content and map the gaps against business goals
- ✓ Build editorial calendars, pillars and messaging frameworks
- ✓ Brief writers, editors and designers, then review the output
- ✓ Report on content performance and adjust the plan quarterly

Think: an architect who only draws blueprints — while a machine now draws them instantly and the client asks why you're billing.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Content audits, calendars, pillar pages, repurposing plans, competitive teardowns — strategy templates plus AI produce the full deck.	Taste, positioning, knowing which customer conversation matters, and standing behind a call in the room. Judgment under accountability is the transferable asset.

⚠ **THE TITLE TRAP: 'strategist' sounds senior and safe. It's the layer AI demos best — the deck was always the deliverable, and decks are free now.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Big-picture work: brands, audiences, narratives ✓ Remote and meeting-light compared to most marketing roles ✓ Every industry needs it, so variety is real	✗ Not protected: your deliverable is a document, and documents are generated ✗ Not clearly measured: when results blur, strategy budgets cut first ✗ Not entry-friendly anymore: teams keep one senior and automate the rest

Good fit? Already a strategist with a sharp niche and client trust — your relationships and taste carry you. Or a founder doing it for your own business.
Bad fit? Beginners choosing it as the 'thinking' marketing job. The thinking got templated; accountability is what's left, and it lives in other titles.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PIVOT TO Market Researcher	DOOR B — PIVOT TO CRM / Email Marketer

A $78,760 median with +7% growth (BLS, Market Research Analysts and Marketing Specialists, 2025–35) and ~82,000 openings a year — the fastest-growing verified door in this whole list. Content strategy is audience research, demand analysis and message testing; this door keeps the research half of your job and drops the production half that got automated. First move: run one small audience or demand study for a business you know and write up the decision it changed.	The same BLS anchor — $78,760 median, +7% growth — reached from the planning side. You already plan lifecycle and editorial systems; here the planning attaches to segmentation, flows and measured revenue instead of a content calendar nobody rereads. First move: map one brand's full email lifecycle — welcome, abandon, win-back — with the triggers and the metric each flow owns.

Smart move: If you're already in: attach yourself to revenue — pipeline, conversion, launches. A strategist who owns a number survives; a strategist who owns a calendar doesn't.
Where you land after: You land where strategy has an owner and a scoreboard — research and lifecycle marketing — instead of a deck nobody rereads.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
RETIRE THE	LEARN THE	RUN ONE	ADD THE	APPLY WHERE	INTERVIEW LIKE

STEP 1 — Retire the title, keep the brain

FREE · TODAY

- List your real assets: audience insight, positioning calls, research
- Stop collecting content frameworks; the pile is not a moat

STEP 2 — Learn the research stack

SELF-PACED · 2-3 WEEKS

- Survey design, customer interviews, basic stats and spreadsheet work
- Translate each strategy artifact you made into research language

STEP 3 — Run one real study

FREE · 2 WEEKS

- Design and run a small audience/demand study end to end
- Write up the finding and the decision it changed — this replaces your portfolio deck

STEP 4 — Add the lifecycle rep

FREE · 3-4 WEEKS

- Design one full email lifecycle with segmentation logic and metrics
- Explain the revenue each flow is supposed to move

STEP 5 — Apply where judgment meets data

FREE · ONGOING

- Market research and CRM/email roles at companies you understand
- Lead with the study and the lifecycle, not the calendars

STEP 6 — Interview like an owner

FREE · ONGOING

- Talk outcomes: what moved because of your call
- Ask what result the role owns — take only roles that have one

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: inventory your judgment assets — insights and calls, not deliverables.

□ Days 1–30: research fundamentals; finish one real audience study with a decision attached.

□ Days 31–60: build the lifecycle case; start applications to research and CRM roles.

□ Days 61–90: interviews running; second study or flow shipped from a target company's market.

□ Day 90: you're a research/lifecycle candidate with proof of judgment — not a deck generator competing with one.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **STRATEGY WITHOUT OWNERSHIP IS A PROMPT** ★